



PRIYA GHANGHAS

Priya Ghanghas has gone from a promising prospect to genuine gold-medal contender with astonishing speed. The 20-year-old from Bhiwani announced herself at the Asian Championships in Ulaanbaatar at the start of the year, winning the 60kg title in her first major elite international tournament. She defeated China's former world champion Yang Chengyu in the quarterfinal before beating North Korea's Won Un-gyong 3-0 for gold.

What makes Ghanghas particularly intriguing is her aggressive style. She likes to fight at close range and packs considerable power into her punches, drawing inspiration from the confidence and attacking mentality of boxers from

Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan. But she is also capable of maintaining her composure when she is trailing. After losing the opening round against Yang, she stayed composed rather than rushing, allowing her to turn the fight around. She demonstrated this quality once again at the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow, losing the first round of her final against Canada's Marie-Bathoul Al-Ahmadih before recovering to win gold.

The Asian Games will represent a significant step up. China, Kazakhstan and Chinese Taipei can provide opponents with Olympic and world-level experience. But Ghanghas has already beaten one former world champion this year and arrives in Japan hungry to win the biggest medal of her career so far.

60 KG